



1885

## INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS FOUNDED

Also known as the Congress Party, this was the first modern nationalist party to emerge within the British colonized countries in Africa and Asia. Meeting for the first time in Bombay (Mumbai) in December, its aim was to achieve greater political representation for educated Indians and political control within the British Raj. After 1920, under Mahatma Gandhi, it campaigned first for major political reform and then spearheaded the movement for Indian independence.

◀ The first Indian National Congress meets

1885

**1887 Buffalo Bill's Wild West** show comes to Britain to celebrate Queen Victoria's Jubilee

**1885 The Canadian Pacific Railway** reaches British Columbia and is completed

**1888 Slavery is abolished in Brazil** after more than 300 years of slave labour

◀ The Eiffel Tower under construction

## 1885 LEOPOLD II CLAIMS THE CONGO

Following the Berlin Conference, King Leopold II of Belgium seized the rubber-rich Congo, which was renamed the Congo Free State. Unlike other European colonizers, Leopold ran the region as a privately owned state for personal gain. His administration became infamous for its excessive brutality, forced labour, and the torture and murder of the Congolese.

▷ Leopold II



1889

## EIFFEL TOWER OPENS

Towering 312 m (1,024ft) over Paris, the Eiffel Tower was unveiled at the World Fair to commemorate the centenary of the French Revolution. Designed by engineer Gustav Eiffel and built by his company, it was the world's tallest man-made structure of the time and took 22 months to complete. The huge wrought-iron structure was criticized by public and artists, but when opened it was an instant success, attracting nearly 12,000 visitors every day.